



Stacked cabinet: Arshdeep has an impressive collection of trophies at home. R. V. MOORTHY

how we should approach a game. There are times you need to look beyond your strength and yet ensure that you find breakthroughs.

In the end, execution is what counts. You can plan and practise a lot, but it's how you perform on match day that matters. You can't be rigid; you need to adapt to the situation and stay flexible.

Fitness and diet are two important aspects for an athlete. Can you shed some light on your fitness regime and your diet plans?

More than diet, fitness is important for the players. When you play multiple formats, your body takes on an immense amount of load, and not always do you have time for recovery.

So, it's about how quickly you

bounce back. The physios and the S&C coaches play a huge role in getting us back in shape. The most crucial part is how fast you can recover. The more you bowl and run, the fitter you get, and of course, the gym sessions are important. There needs to be a balance.

I am not too strict about my diet. I eat whatever I like, and since I come from a Punjabi household, *mere khaane mein swaad bhi zaroori hai* (taste is a necessity in my food). There have to be spices and butter in my food (laughs). But that does not mean I have burgers and all that stuff. I look for healthier options that are both nutritious and tasty. However, you need to avoid overeating and burn calories to remain healthy and fitter.

What's your favourite food?

When I'm at home, I really enjoy the *rajma chawal* my mom cooks. I also love having *aloo ke parathe*, sweet curd, and *lassi* for breakfast once a

week. Although I don't eat these regularly because of my diet, I always make sure to have *paratha* for breakfast and *rajma chawal* for lunch when I return home after a series.

How do you unwind?

I love sleeping, though it's been a bit challenging lately due to jet lag. When I'm stressed or overwhelmed, I find that sleeping helps me start fresh. I also enjoy cycling, but these days it's harder to get out because of the selfies and autograph requests I receive. Despite that, cycling remains a genuine passion of mine.

You spoke about selfie requests from the fans. Do you enjoy this attention?

I've received a lot of love since coming home from the T20 World Cup and I'm truly grateful. Inspiring young fans brings me great joy, and I always try to oblige fans with selfies and autographs. It's an honour to